

## Task 11: Phishing Attack Simulation & Detection

### 1) Understand Phishing:

- Phishing is a social engineering attack to trick users into revealing sensitive data
- Common types: email phishing, spear phishing, smishing
- Attackers use urgency, fear, and trust
- Humans are often the weakest link

### 2) Install GoPhish:

sudo apt update:

```
(hari@vbox)-[~]
$ sudo apt update
[sudo] password for hari:
Get:1 http://mirrors.esto.network/kali kali-rolling InRelease [34.0 kB]
Get:2 http://mirrors.esto.network/kali kali-rolling/main amd64 Packages [20.6 MB]
Get:3 http://mirrors.esto.network/kali kali-rolling/main amd64 Contents (deb) [51.9 MB]
Get:4 http://mirrors.esto.network/kali kali-rolling/contrib amd64 Packages [117 kB]
Get:5 http://mirrors.esto.network/kali kali-rolling/contrib amd64 Contents (deb) [268 kB]
Get:6 http://mirrors.esto.network/kali kali-rolling/non-free amd64 Packages [188 kB]
Get:7 http://mirrors.esto.network/kali kali-rolling/non-free amd64 Contents (deb) [890 kB]
Fetched 74.1 MB in 3min 59s (309 kB/s)
2058 packages can be upgraded. Run 'apt list --upgradable' to see them.
```

sudo apt install golang -y:

```
(hari@vbox)-[~]
$ sudo apt install golang -y
The following package was automatically installed and is no longer required:
libconfig-inifiles-perl
Use 'sudo apt autoremove' to remove it.

Installing:
golang

Installing dependencies:
golang-1.24      golang-1.24-go  golang-doc  golang-src  pkgconf
golang-1.24-doc golang-1.24-src golang-go   libpkgconf3  pkgconf-bin

Suggested packages:
bzip2 | bzip2 mercurial

Summary:
Upgrading: 0, Installing: 11, Removing: 0, Not Upgrading: 2058
Download size: 50.2 MB
Space needed: 260 MB / 10.3 GB available
```

git clone <https://github.com/gophish/gophish.git>:

```
(hari@vbox)-[~]
$ git clone https://github.com/gophish/gophish.git
Cloning into 'gophish'...
remote: Enumerating objects: 8104, done.
remote: Total 8104 (delta 0), reused 0 (delta 0), pack-reused 8104 (from 1)
Receiving objects: 100% (8104/8104), 54.40 MiB | 222.00 KiB/s, done.
Resolving deltas: 100% (4848/4848), done.
```

cd gophish:

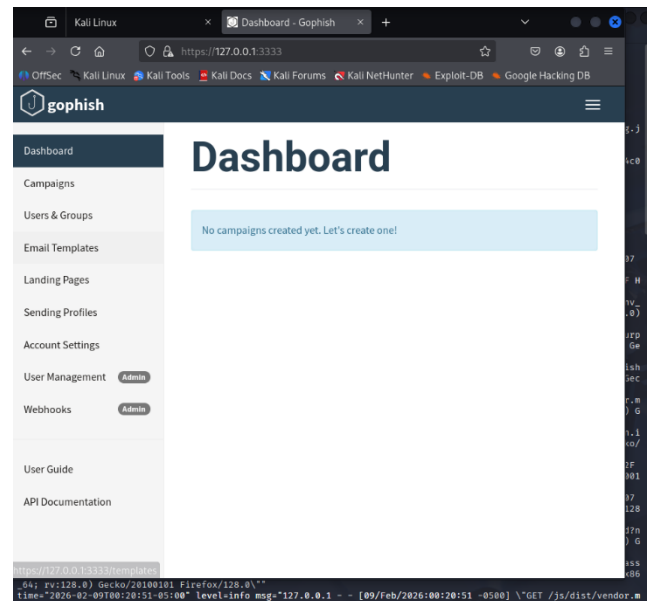
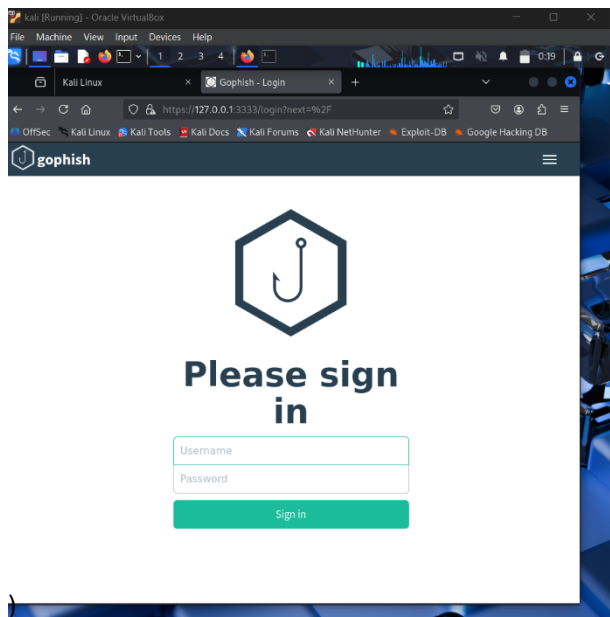
Run:

sudo ./gophish

```
(hari@vbox)-[~/gophish]
$ sudo ./gophish
[sudo] password for hari:
time="2026-02-09T00:13:38-05:00" level=warning msg="No contact address has been configured."
time="2026-02-09T00:13:38-05:00" level=warning msg="Please consider adding a contact_address entry in your config.js"
son"
goose: no migrations to run. current version: 20220321133237
time="2026-02-09T00:13:38-05:00" level=info msg="Please login with the username 'admin' and the password '1234567890'"
'ae"
time="2026-02-09T00:13:38-05:00" level=info msg="Starting admin server at https://127.0.0.1:3333"
time="2026-02-09T00:13:38-05:00" level=info msg="Starting IMAP monitor manager"
time="2026-02-09T00:13:38-05:00" level=info msg="Background Worker Started Successfully - Waiting for Campaigns"
time="2026-02-09T00:13:38-05:00" level=info msg="Starting new IMAP monitor for user admin"
time="2026-02-09T00:13:38-05:00" level=info msg="Starting phishing server at http://0.0.0.0:8081"
```

Access:

https://127.0.0.1:3333



### 3) Create a Fake Email Template (Awareness Only):

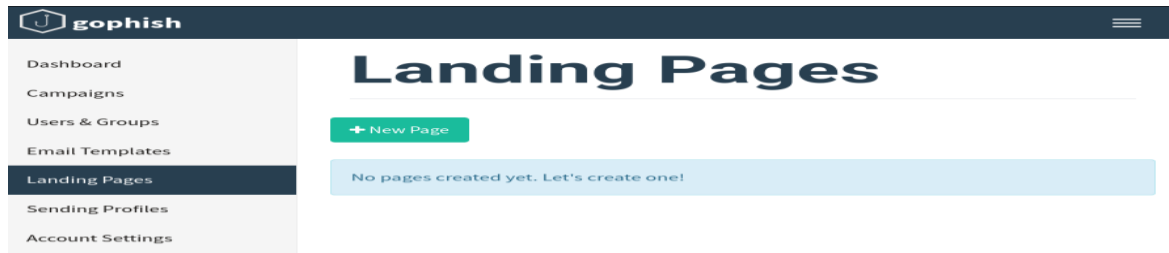
Subject:

Body (educational):

Email templates were created strictly for security awareness training.

#### 4) Go to Landing Pages

Go to Landing Pages:



New Page:

Create Awareness Landing Page:

### New Landing Page

Name:

Phishing Awareness Landing Page

Import Site

Import Site

HTML



```
<h2>Phishing Awareness Simulation</h2>

<p>
You have clicked on a simulation phishing link.
This page is a part if a cybersecurity awareness exercise.
</p>

<p>
No personal information is collected.
No credentials are stored.
</p>
```

☐ Capture Submitted Data ?

Cancel

Save Page

**Uncheck:** "Capture Submitted Data"

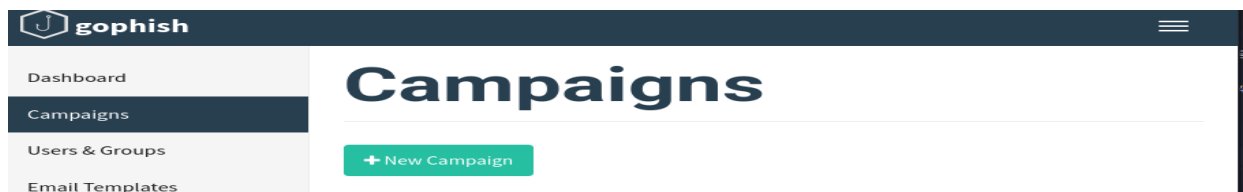
**Uncheck:** "Capture Passwords"

No data harvesting Only Ethical simulation.

## 5) Simulate Sending & Tracking(Only Educational/Internship Purpose):

For this internship task, you are NOT required to actually send phishing emails to real users. This step is about understanding HOW phishing campaigns are sent and tracked, not executing a real attack.

Open Campaigns Section:



Click “New Campaign”:

Fill Campaign Details:

**Name:**

**Email Template:**

**Landing Page:**

**URL:**

**Launch Date**

**Send Emails By (Optional)**

**Sending Profile:**

**Groups:**

Only Internship/Educational Purpose:

## 6) Track Responses:

**Email Opened:** This metric indicates whether a user has opened the phishing email. It helps assess how many users interact with suspicious emails.

**Link Clicked:** This metric tracks whether a user clicked on the link embedded in the phishing email. Clicking links is a strong indicator of susceptibility to phishing attacks.

- No emails were sent
  - No users were targeted
  - No links were clicked
  - No data was collected
- 
- Emails sent → **0**
  - Clicks → **0**
  - Data submitted → **0**

This is intentional and ethical.